

2.1.1 Online Social Networking

You may have heard some of your friends or acquaintances talk about sites such as Orkut, Hi5, Friendster, or Yahoo! 360. These are what are popularly known as online social networking sites.

While they all claim to have the 'most active' or the 'widest' network in the world, you need to first check on where your friends are. Last thing you'd want is to be in one place while your friends are in another! It can also be compared with your friends being at the movies while you are waiting for them at the coffee shop.

Getting online with almost all these social networking sites is as simple as a free sign-up and registration. In the case of some



hi5 is "fun, safe and easy"



Orkut is somewhat slow, but very popular

Tip

Use emoticons and acronyms when necessary to convey your message. If you are joking, include a smiley face :-), if you are sad or upset you can use :-(. If you are unsure of someone's intent or meaning, ask them before making assumptions and accusations that you may regret. Don't assume what anyone means - take them at their word - same as you should expect to be responsible for every word that you type.